

Organizational behaviour Course reflection journal

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REFLECTION #1

Topic: Motivation

Before taking Organizational Behaviour, I believed motivation was simply about working hard. Growing up, I was taught that if I put in enough effort and stayed disciplined, I would eventually achieve my goals. As someone who moved to Canada to pursue a degree in Computer Science, that mindset has always been one of my greatest strengths. Whenever I struggled with an assignment or found programming difficult, I reminded myself to keep working because I believed success came from persistence alone. Although I still believe hard work is important, this course showed me that motivation is much more complex than I originally thought.

Learning about different aspects of motivation helped me realize that people are motivated by more than just money or personal ambition. Everyone wants to feel recognized, respected, and valued for the work they do. This stood out to me because I began thinking about situations where people lose motivation even though they are talented and hardworking. I realized that when employees feel ignored, have no opportunities to grow, or believe that their efforts are barely appreciated, they naturally lose motivation over time. It is not always because they have become lazy; sometimes the environment around them discourages them from giving their best.

Reflecting on my own experiences as a student, I realized there have been times when I felt discouraged after spending hours studying for a difficult course or working on an assignment that seemed impossible to understand. During those moments, encouragement from a professor, positive feedback, or simply seeing my own progress made a huge difference. Those experiences helped me understand that motivation is not something that stays the same forever. It changes depending on how supported and confident a person feels.

Looking back, motivation is one of the lessons from this course that I will always remember. It reminded me that achieving success is not only about pushing people to work harder but also about helping them feel valued, supported, and inspired to keep on growing. As I continue to work toward my future career, I hope to build that kind of environment for both myself and the people I will one day work with.

REFLECTION #2

Topic: Leadership

My personal understanding of leadership has changed significantly since beginning this course. I initially thought that leadership was mainly about being confident, making decisions, and telling people what needed to be done. Although I knew qualities like communication and responsibility were important, I had never really stopped to think about which characteristics mattered most in a leader. One of my biggest takeaways from this course was realising that trust is truly the foundation of good leadership. I learned that without trust, it becomes very difficult for people to believe in their leader, work together effectively, and feel motivated to give their best.

One activity that really stood out to me was when our class was asked to think about the most important leadership qualities. At first, I focused on characteristics such as confidence, communication, and knowledge because those were the qualities that I normally associated with successful leaders. However, as we shared our ideas with the class, I found it interesting to hear the different opinions everyone had. Some people believed that honesty was the most important, while others emphasized empathy or charisma. That activity made me think more deeply about leaders I have admired throughout my life. Whether they were teachers, managers, or classmates leading group projects, the people I respected most were those I could trust. They treated others fairly, gave me a voice, and listened to different opinions. I realised that I was never inspired by someone simply because they had authority. Instead, I respected people whose actions consistently matched their words. This helped me understand that trust is something leaders earn over time through their everyday behaviours rather than something that automatically comes with a leadership position.

Looking back at everything that I learned from the course, this was one of the most meaningful takeaways I got from Organizational Behaviour. The classroom activity encouraged me to think more carefully about what leadership really means, and listening to my classmates' ideas helped broaden my perspective. As I continue through university and eventually begin my future career, I hope to become the kind of leader people trust because of my actions, not simply because of my position.

REFLECTION #3

Topic: Personality

One of the most meaningful topics we discussed in class was personality, particularly the idea of nature vs nurture. I had never really thought about where personality comes from. I simply assumed people were born a certain way and their personalities stayed the same throughout their lives. Learning about how personality is shaped by both our genetics and our life experiences completely changed the way I think about myself and other people.

What actually stood out to me the most was realizing that who we become is not determined entirely by what we are born with. Our upbringing, environment, culture, and the people we surround ourselves with all influence how we think and behave. At the same time, we each have our own natural tendencies that make us unique. Understanding that personality is influenced by both nature and nurture reminded me that everyone has a different story that shapes who they are.

Reflecting on my own life, moving from Nigeria to Canada to study at this university has challenged me in so many ways and has helped me grow as a person. I have become more independent, more open to different perspectives, and more willing to step outside my comfort zone. Looking back, I realize that while some parts of my personality have always been there, many others have developed because of the experiences I have had and the people I have met along the way. That realization gave me confidence because it showed me that personal growth is always possible.

Another important takeaway was that I should not be so quick to judge other people based on first impressions. Earlier on, if someone was quiet, reserved, or approached situations differently than I did, I sometimes assumed that was simply “who they were.” Now I understand that personality is much more complex. People’s behaviours can be influenced by their background and experiences. This encouraged me to become more understanding and open-minded when working with others.

Learning about personality was much more than studying another theory. It changed the way I see both myself and the people around me. I now understand that who we are is shaped by both nature and nurture, and that personal growth never truly stops. This is a lesson I will carry with me throughout the rest of my life because understanding people is just as important as understanding the technical work we do.

REFLECTION #4

Topic: Emotional Intelligence

A concept that really had a big impact on me during this course was emotional intelligence. Before this course, I had heard the term before, but I never fully understood what it meant. I assumed it simply referred to being kind or showing empathy towards others and being able to recognise where it's needed, but I realized that it is much deeper than that. It involves understanding my own emotions, recognizing how my behaviour affects other people, and being able to manage my emotions while building positive relationships with those around me. This completely changed the way I think about interacting with others.

What made this topic meaningful to me is that emotional intelligence is something I have always wanted to develop without even realizing it. I have always admired people who remain calm during stressful situations, listen carefully before responding, and make others feel respected and understood. Before this course, I thought those qualities were simply part of someone's personality. I now understand that emotional intelligence is a skill that can be developed through self-awareness, self-control, empathy, and effective communication.

I also began thinking about how important emotional intelligence is in the workplace. It is easy to assume that the smartest or most technically skilled people will automatically become the best employees or leaders. However, this course taught me that technical ability alone is not enough. Organizations are built around people, and people work best when they feel respected, supported, and understood. Someone who cannot communicate effectively, manage conflict, or understand the emotions of others may struggle to build strong working relationships no matter how talented they are. Emotional intelligence helps create trust, improves teamwork, and allows people to work through challenges without damaging relationships.

Emotional intelligence is one of those takeaways that I will carry with me long after this course is over. It taught me that success in an organization is not measured by intelligence or ability but also by how well we understand ourselves and the people we work with. I hope to keep developing my emotional intelligence because I believe it will help me become a better teammate, a better leader, and even a better person.

REFLECTION #5

Topic: Thinking hats

One of the most enjoyable topics we explored during the course was Edward de Bono's six thinking hats. After learning about each hat and reflecting on my own approach to problem-solving, I realized that it helped me understand how I naturally think and how to become a better decision maker. One of my biggest takeaways from this activity was discovering that I relate most to the Blue Hat and the Yellow Hat.

As we discussed the different thinking hats in class, I found myself comparing each one to the way I approach school, group work, and everyday decisions. I recognised many of my own habits in the Blue Hat because I enjoy planning, staying organised, creating schedules, and thinking about how to guide a task from beginning to end. I like having a clear direction before I begin working, and I often feel more confident when I have a plan in place. At the same time, I also connected with the Yellow Hat because I naturally like to stay optimistic and focus on possibilities rather than obstacles. Even when something is difficult, I usually try to believe that there is a solution if I continue learning and working towards it.

As I prepare for a career in computer science, I know I will constantly be solving complex problems with other people. Building software and develop new technology. These all require creativity, organization, critical thinking, and optimism. While I naturally identify with Blue and Yellow Hats, I also want to become more comfortable with using the other thinking styles when situations require them. I believe becoming a well-rounded thinker will help me make better decisions, communicate more effectively, and contribute more successfully to the teams I work with.

The six thinking hats activity taught me more than my preferred thinking style. It challenged me to think critically about how I approach problems and how other people approach them differently. More importantly, it reminded me that successful employees and leaders are not limited to one way of thinking. They know when to adapt their perspective and appreciate the strengths of others. I want to become someone who not only solves problems effectively but also helps others feel that their ideas and ways of thinking are valued.